You Only Have 7 Weeks Until 2027 – EP 343

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Nov 13, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cXOJHSz0xBs Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter uses the Jensen Huang/Nvidia scandal to teach a "never appear too perfect" lesson from Robert Greene, then delivers a detailed 6-week fat-loss protocol (diet math, 20K steps, lifting), and handles live Q&A on productivity and business.

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💼 Sponsor Spots & Upcoming Events 1:02

- **GoHighLevel** — Brandon's CRM of choice for ~10 years
  - Used for all websites, email/text campaigns, and sales team management
  - Free 30-day trial + bonus AI tools via link in description
- **Live In-Person AI Training (Miami)**
  - Dates: November 21st and January 23rd
  - 20 entrepreneurs max; bring a laptop (can bring one team member)
  - Deliverables: set up funnels, lead follow-up, client support, content systems — all live
  - Brandon claims he produced **over 1,000 pieces of content in one month** with no team, just AI
  - Pitched as a "one-person army" business model
- **Free Virtual Training (Sunday, 7 PM EST)**
  - Topic: how personal trainers can make an extra **$300–$500/day** using AI

    - Open to anyone worldwide; register via link in description
    - Student testimonials shown:
        - **Anna Quinn** (Dallas, 22 yrs old): $0 → ~$80K in 8 months of online coaching
        - **Karen**: $245K for the year; $10K last month
        - **Will**: $5,940 in his first 7 days; $32K+ since August 8th (not certified, no big following)
        - **Leonardo** (Mexico): small following, not certified → $39K in one month (new record)
- Brandon states he has helped **15,000+ people** grow online fitness businesses over ~8 years

🕵️ The Jensen Huang / Nvidia Scandal 16:37

- Jensen Huang, CEO of a **$4.5 trillion company**, admitted to an affair with someone alleged to be a spy
    - Reports then surfaced of a second, then a **third** affair
    - He subsequently **resigned** as CEO
    - Brandon notes his wife stands to receive approximately **$81 billion** in a potential divorce
- Comparison to **Elon Musk**: known publicly for multiple relationships and children, alleged ketamine use in DOGE offices — yet faces no career consequences
- Comparison to **Tiger Woods** (Thanksgiving 2009 incident):
    - Lost **$25–$50 million/year** in endorsements
    - Shareholders in Tiger-linked businesses lost **$5–$12 billion**
    - Game suffered for roughly a decade afterward
- Comparison to **Charlie Sheen** (~2010):
    - Highest-paid TV actor ever at **$1.8 million per episode**
    - Caught in a hotel with hookers and cocaine — was NOT fired for that
    - Was eventually fired only for **talking trash about his employer**
    - Continued earning ~**$40 million/year** throughout
- Core question Brandon poses: why do some public figures survive scandal while others don't?

📖 48 Laws of Power: Never Appear Too Perfect 23:01

- Reference: **"The 48 Laws of Power"** by Robert Greene — **Law 46: Never Appear Too Perfect**
    - Greene advises occasionally displaying your defects and shortcomings to seem more human and approachable
    - Brandon's thesis: when you project a flawless image, people secretly resent it; when reality contradicts the image, the backlash is severe
- Tiger Woods = squeaky-clean family man image → betrayal felt → massive public punishment
- Charlie Sheen / Elon Musk = bad-boy/rebel image already established → scandals fit the brand → no punishment

- Jensen Huang = **33 years** of no scandals, on a pedestal, "dishwasher at Denny's built a trillion-dollar company" story → public feels deceived
- **The Pratfall Effect** (1966 study by psychologist Elliot Aronson):
  - Participants listened to tapes of someone trying out for a college quiz team
  - One version: a genius who spills coffee — **more likable**
  - One version: an average guy who spills coffee — **less likable**
  - Key finding: showing imperfection only *helps* you if you're already highly competent; it humanizes competence
- Greene's historical example: an ancient Athenian politician perceived as perfectly honest — when minor wrongdoing was discovered, the **entire city exiled him**
- Fitness industry parallel: someone who claimed to be natural and is later revealed to be on steroids = big scandal; someone who built their channel *around* PEDs = no scandal

> The lesson: people don't hate your flaws — they hate being lied to about them.

🪞 How to Apply "Own Your Flaws" in Real Life 33:28

- **Step 1 — Show your flaws proactively**
  - Brandon's example: publicly disclosed his **dyslexia** diagnosis so misspellings are understood, not damaging
  - Don't wait for people to discover your imperfections; put them on display yourself
- **Step 2 — Be radically transparent**
  - When Brandon started **TRT (Testosterone Replacement Therapy)** in his 40s, he made full YouTube documentaries, showed bloodwork, interviewed his doctors multiple times
  - When he started **peptides** earlier in the year, he documented the whole journey from day one
  - Result: older men who were ashamed of TRT told him "you made it normal"
  - Note: every man's natural testosterone begins declining around age 30
- **Step 3 — Own it completely**
  - Don't half-apologize or hide — lean into it, make it part of your brand
  - Brandon: "I'd rather be Charlie Sheen than Tiger Woods"
- **Why this matters psychologically:**
  - If people like a *facade* version of you, their praise doesn't feel real
  - When internet criticism hits (and it always does), it's the insecurities you're hiding that hurt most
  - Evolutionary note: humans evolved in tribes of **~150–200 people**; ostracism historically meant death → we are hardwired to care what others think; "I don't care what people think" denies human biology
  - Brandon's calf example: criticism of a confident area rolls off; criticism of a real insecurity (his calves — "my biggest physical insecurity") stings → that's why he does **8 sets of calf raises a day**

- Broader point: privacy is essentially over; "those days are gone — maybe 10 years ago you could keep secrets"
  - Better strategy: own everything before it comes out

🏋️ How to Lose 20 Pounds by Christmas: The Full Protocol 1:06:40

- Brandon frames this as an aggressive, no-excuses plan for people with ~6 weeks until Christmas
- Credentials stated: **27+ years** as a personal trainer, trained **thousands of people** across all demographics
- Core logic: start NOW, not January 1st — arrive at New Year already in shape with momentum

Diet Formula

Metric	Formula
Daily calories	Body weight (lbs) × 10
Daily protein	1 gram × body weight (lbs)
Example (220 lbs person)	2,200 calories, 220g protein

- You do NOT have to do keto — diet style is at your discretion
- The only non-negotiables are **total calories** and **protein grams**
- Fats vs. carbs split = personal preference
- **Why so much protein?**
  - Muscle preservation in a deep caloric deficit (catabolic state) requires more protein than muscle-building in a surplus
  - **Thermogenic effect of food (TEF):** protein burns **20–30%** of its own calories during digestion; fat burns **0–3%**; carbs burn **10–15%** → protein is like a "cash-back credit card"
  - Eating 100 calories of protein = only ~70–80 calories actually absorbed
  - Protein is the most satiating macronutrient — keeps you fuller longer
- Do NOT drink calories — only zero-calorie liquids (water, black coffee, pre-workout, green tea with Splenda)
- Brandon personally drinks **1–2 gallons of water per day**
- Brandon's own foods: chicken thighs/drumsticks (baked/grilled), eggs (whole yolk), green vegetables, berries, ground beef, Caesar salads — consistent with 11-year keto practice
- Brandon keeps **net carbs under 50g/day** but says you don't have to

🥩 What to Eat & How to Track Calories 1:26:19

- **Tracking tool:** Brandon used MyFitnessPal for years; now uses **Claude AI** (also works in ChatGPT, Gemini)
  - Has a pinned chat with a custom prompt (link in description)
  - Weighs food with a **food scale** — carries it everywhere, including Michelin-star restaurants

    - If he can't weigh, he photographs the meal and uploads it to Claude for an estimate — "within margin of error I'm comfortable with"
- **Claude dashboard Brandon uses:** logs protein, calories consumed, calories burned (via Oura Ring), net carbs, water, deficit/surplus
    - His September–present averages: **259g protein/day**, **2,450 calories/day consumed**, **~2,534 calories burned/day**, **~80 calorie average deficit** (maintenance phase, not cutting)
- Keto side benefits Brandon cites (not required for fat loss):
    - Clear skin — excess glucose breaks down collagen; less glucose = fewer wrinkles
    - Hasn't been sick in **11 years**, no COVID despite close exposure (girlfriend had it 3+ times)
    - Immune system boost backed by studies
- **Artificial sweeteners:** Brandon is a fan of Splenda, Truvia, aspartame — calls fears "stupid" with no one ever dying from them
- **Protein shakes:** best calorie-to-protein ratio; whey protein is the #1 ingredient in baby formula — "babies are tough enough for it, so are you"

🚶 Cardio: 20,000 Steps Per Day 1:31:51

- Brandon's preferred cardio: **walking**, not high-intensity cardio
- **Why walking beats running for fat loss:**
    - Running 1 mile burns ~**100 calories** → you'd need to run **8 miles/day** to match walking's calorie burn
    - High-intensity cardio spikes **ghrelin and leptin** (hunger hormones) → you eat more to compensate, often wiping out the calorie burn
    - Hard on joints and central nervous system → requires recovery time → hurts your lifting
    - Sprinting tears ACLs even in healthy pro athletes — not appropriate for deconditioned people
- **Calorie math for 20,000 steps:**
    - Average person burns **800–900 calories** walking 20,000 steps
    - Over 42 days (6 weeks): 800 × 42 = **33,600 calories** ÷ 3,500 (calories per lb of fat) = **~9.6 lbs of fat** from walking alone
    - Combined with caloric deficit from diet → reaches ~20 lbs total
- **How to hit 20,000 steps daily:**
    - Morning walk upon waking: **30 minutes = ~3,000 steps**
    - Walk after lunch: **30 minutes = ~3,000 steps**
    - Walk after work: **1 hour = ~6,000 steps** (make it social — walk club with friends/family)
    - **Cheat code:** every hour while working, take a **10-minute walk = ~8,000 additional steps**
- If your job won't let you leave your desk for 10 minutes an hour: "sounds like you're doing some real low-level stuff" — Brandon has ~20 fully remote employees and only cares about deliverables, not clock-watching

- Key point: **lift heavy while cutting** — don't turn weight sessions into cardio/aerobics with light weights; heavy lifting signals the body to retain muscle

💪 Weight Training While Cutting 1:42:25

- Frequency: **3–4 full-body workouts per week**
- Structure per session:
  - **1–2 exercises per body part**
  - **3–4 sets per exercise**
  - **90-second rest** between sets (timed with Apple Watch)
  - **Superset opposing muscle groups** to cut time
    - Example: incline dumbbell press → immediately bent-over dumbbell rows, then rest 90 sec
    - Example: cable curls → immediately cable pushdowns
- Total session time: ~**1 hour**
- Common mistake: wasting time between sets on phones/chatting
- Purpose of lifting while in deficit: preserves muscle mass; diet burns fat, lifting keeps muscle
- Must lift **heavy** — light weights do not send the muscle-retention signal

🎄 Surviving the Holiday "Mediocre Marathon" 1:46:38

- Brandon calls the period from **Thanksgiving through New Year's** the "Mediocre Marathon"
  - Average American gains **5–10 lbs of fat** during the holidays
  - Threat sequence: Halloween candy → office parties → family Thanksgiving → Christmas dinner → New Year's
- **The "Mediocre Mantras"** to avoid:
  - "I can just have one" — one day of cheating induces cravings for days after
  - "One day won't hurt" — it has been hurting you your whole life
- Brandon's personal rule: **no cheat days** — has been cheat-day-free for **4+ years**
  - After stopping cheat days, all cravings disappeared; diet adherence no longer requires discipline
  - Brings his food scale to Thanksgiving and Christmas; family is used to it
- **Key holiday tactic: don't eat the leftovers**
  - Option: don't host Thanksgiving/Christmas at home
  - If you must host, give most food away immediately after the meal
- **No alcohol** — alcohol slows fat-burning, disrupts hormones, and kills sleep quality; Brandon hasn't drunk in **11+ years**
- **If you mess up:**
  - Forgive yourself and move on immediately
  - "Don't mess up twice in a row" — once is a mistake, twice starts building a new (bad) habit

💊 Supplements & Performance Aids 1:53:15

- **Caffeine**
  - Brandon currently takes **300–600 mg/day** (previously up to 1,000 mg/day since age 16)
  - Benefits: energy for 20K steps + workouts; blunts hunger in a caloric deficit
  - Studies show caffeine aids fat-burning process
  - Don't copy his dose — start lower
- **Protein shakes**
  - Best calorie-to-protein ratio of any food
  - Brandon drinks several per day to hit high protein targets while staying low-calorie
  - Whey protein = number one ingredient in infant formula
- **GLP-1 Peptides (Tirzepatide / "Triseptide")**
  - Brandon's "closest thing to a miracle drug" after ~30 years in fitness
  - Mechanism: dramatically suppresses hunger — "you don't even think about food"
  - His personal experience: made an aggressive pre-summer cut "fucking easy" compared to doing it without
  - He also tried **Retatrutide** for one week — it made him *hungrier*; not recommended
  - FDA approved; get it from a doctor
  - Brandon has no affiliate deal — purely personal endorsement
  - **Critical caveat:** must still track calories on a GLP-1 because you won't accidentally eat enough protein — hunger suppression is so strong you may under-eat protein
  - Analogy: dieting without GLP = going to a physical library using the Dewey Decimal System; dieting with GLP = doing a school report from an iPad at home
  - Pushback on "it's lazy" criticism: "there's no honor in doing things the hard way" — people don't judge you for using a TV remote, Google, or cars
- **On sustainability criticism:**
  - Brandon rejects the "this isn't sustainable" argument for fat loss
  - A caloric deficit IS mild starvation — you should NOT sustain it
  - Goal: get as lean as possible as fast as possible, then switch to **maintenance calories** (body weight × 15) and **1–1.5g protein per lb of body weight**

❓ Live Q&A: Project Management, Doom Scrolling, Effort & More 12:41

- **Q: Best tool to manage a team and projects with real-time dashboards?**
  - Recommended: **Notion database**
    - Each task gets its own entry with an assigned person and a **hard due date**
    - Set up a **Kanban board**: To Do → In Progress → Done

        - Brandon prefers Notion over Trello; finds Asana and Basecamp "more complicated than they need to be"
    - Advanced workflow: use **AI meeting notetakers** (Fathom, Granola, Fireflies) to capture Zoom calls, then have an AI agent auto-populate the Notion database with every task, assignee, and deadline from the meeting
    - Proactive follow-up: set an AI agent to alert you "Deadline for James's proposal is 48 hours away — want me to draft a check-in message?"
- **Q: How much daily effort shows someone is truly working hard?**
    - Answer: **working at capacity** — not "hustle" or "grinding" but truly maximum output given your responsibilities
    - Reference: **"The Science of Getting Rich"** by Wallace D. Wattles (the book *The Secret* was allegedly based on)
        - Key phrase (written in all-caps in the book): **"Do all that can be done each day"**
        - Brandon's interpretation: if you do ALL you can do, EVERY day, "it is very difficult to fail"
    - Brandon's personal example: woke at 7 AM, working within 5 minutes, worked through the podcast, will work out after, then do more work before sleep
    - "Every day" means birthdays, weekends, holidays — not sometimes, not most of the time
    - Very few people actually do this; most find time for other things
- **Q: How to break doom-scrolling and porn addiction; stay focused?**
    - Core philosophy: **"Discipline is for amateurs"** — set up your environment so discipline isn't needed
    - Tactical steps:
        - Put your phone **in another room** when working
        - Brandon sometimes charges his phone in the bathroom as a distraction barrier
        - Put social media only on an **iPad** (not phone) — the iPad experience is worse, so it's less tempting
        - Make phone screen **black and white** (tip from Alex Hormozi) — Hormozi said his screen time dropped dramatically
        - Install **website-blocking apps** on your computer for porn sites
        - **Plan every hour of every day** in your calendar — "white space is where the devil lives"
        - Add more friction between you and bad habits; reduce friction between you and good habits
    - On cravings: abstinence is easier than moderation — stop cold turkey, cravings fade, then you no longer need discipline
    - Heroin analogy: Vietnam soldiers addicted to heroin largely quit when they returned to the US simply because it wasn't available — environment change did the work
- **Q: Shave head for easier content filming?**
    - Brandon endorses it — has shaved his own head since age 16 (started with a full head of hair by choice)
    - Suggests using ChatGPT to generate a bald photo first to check head shape
    - "Hair grows back — what do you have to lose?"

- **Notable super chat mentions:**
  - Community member using Brandon's tactics in car sales: touching **$15K/month**
  - Mix and match show: saved **$10K in 30 days**
  - Roofer in Texas helping his guys get rich from Brandon's teachings